

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Contractor-Grade Budget

No budget yet? We build one from scratch — full takeoffs, real 2026 NC trade-network unit costs, written assumptions, and a bid-ready spreadsheet. The number you'd otherwise pay a GC to assemble, without hiring one.

PREPARED FOR

Sample Investor · budget built from scratch · Charlotte NC
\$1,799 · NC GC License #107724

HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Takeoffs, not guesses

This budget was built the way a GC builds a bid: measured quantities (takeoffs) for each trade, priced against current NC trade-network unit costs, with every assumption written down so you can defend the number to a contractor or a lender.

INPUT	SOURCE
Quantities (sf, lf, counts)	Takeoff from plans + photos
Unit costs	2026 NC trade-network pricing
Labor multipliers	Charlotte submarket, current cycle
Allowances	Finish level: Market-Standard (Tier 2)

BUDGET SUMMARY

The number, by category

\$104,200

Bid-ready total · Market-Standard finish · 1,420 sf · 2026 Charlotte pricing.

CATEGORY	AMOUNT	% OF TOTAL
Demo + site	\$3,000	3%
Systems (HVAC/plumb/elec)	\$24,400	23%
Kitchen / bath	\$30,100	29%
Finishes (floor/paint/trim)	\$21,300	20%
Envelope (roof/window/ext)	\$16,200	16%
GC + permits + contingency	\$9,200	9%

LINE-ITEM DETAIL (1 OF 2)

Quantity × unit cost

ITEM	QTY	UNIT	TOTAL
Demo + dumpster	1,420 sf	\$2.10/sf	\$2,982
Roof — arch shingle	18 sq	\$525/sq	\$9,450
HVAC — 3-ton + furnace	1 ea	\$9,600	\$9,600
Plumbing re-pipe (PEX)	1,420 sf	\$5.40/sf	\$7,668
Bath rebuild	1 ea	\$8,200	\$8,200
Electrical — 200A + devices	1 ea	\$5,600	\$5,600
LVP flooring	1,050 sf	\$5.20/sf	\$5,460

LINE-ITEM DETAIL (2 OF 2)

Quantity × unit cost

ITEM	QTY	UNIT	TOTAL
Kitchen cabinets (mid)	18 lf	\$420/lf	\$7,560
Quartz counters	42 sf	\$78/sf	\$3,276
Appliances (SS package)	1 ea	\$4,200	\$4,200
Interior paint	1,420 sf	\$2.80/sf	\$3,976
Exterior paint	1 ea	\$3,400	\$3,400
Trim + interior doors	1 ea	\$3,800	\$3,800
Windows (partial)	8 ea	\$520/ea	\$4,160

ASSUMPTIONS + EXCLUSIONS

What this number assumes

ASSUMED	EXCLUDED (priced separately if found)
Sound foundation + framing	Structural repair
Clay sewer intact	Sewer lateral replacement
No asbestos / lead remediation	Hazmat abatement
Standard Mecklenburg permit path	Variance / rezoning
Market-Standard finish level	Premium / custom upgrades

WHY THIS MATTERS

A budget without written assumptions is a number you can't defend. When a contractor's bid comes in different, this page tells you whether it's a real difference or a scope misunderstanding.

ALLOWANCES + CONTINGENCY

Where flexibility is built in

ALLOWANCE	INCLUDED	NOTE
Cabinet allowance	\$7,560	Semi-custom; upgrade swaps net to budget
Fixture allowance	\$2,400	Mid-grade; itemized in spreadsheet
Flooring allowance	\$5,460	LVP; hardwood refinish priced separate
Contingency	\$5,200	5% — raise to 10% for pre-1970 risk

HOW TO USE THIS BUDGET

From spreadsheet to execution

BID AGAINST IT

Hand contractors the scope + this line-item budget so every bid prices the same thing. The bids that come back wildly off are telling you something — usually a scope gap, not a better price.

FUND AGAINST IT

The category breakdown maps to a lender draw schedule. This is the document that gets a construction loan released without back-and-forth.

DELIVERED AS A LIVE SPREADSHEET

You also receive the editable spreadsheet — adjust finishes, quantities, or allowances and the totals recompute. The PDF is the snapshot; the spreadsheet is the working file.

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